

CompTIA A+ Core 1 Playbook

IT Labs

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Install SATA Devices

You work part-time at a computer repair store. You are building a new computer. A customer has purchased two serial ATA (SATA) hard drives for his computer.

In this lab, your task is to install both hard drives on the computer.

- Read the motherboard documentation to identify the location of the internal SATA connectors.
- Install the hard drives and connect them to the motherboard.
- Plug in the correct power connector from the power supply for both drives.
- Boot the computer into the BIOS and verify that both drives are detected.

Installing hard drives in the simulated interface can be a bit tricky. Keep in mind the following tips:

- Add the drives to the computer using the **Drive Bays** view.
- The SATA connectors on the hard drives are visible in the **Drive Bays** view.
- To connect a SATA cable from a hard drive to the motherboard, use the **Workspace** tab to view partial connections.
- To connect the power supply, switch to the **Drive Bays** view. In the **Workspace** tab, find the power supply inside the **System Case**, then use the **Selected Item** pane to find the appropriate connectors.

Windows is not installed, so the operating system will not start.

Complete this lab as follows:

1. Identify the port locations for SATA connectors on the motherboard.
 1. Above the computer, select **Motherboard** to switch to the motherboard view.
 2. Select the **Motherboard**.
 3. From the Selected Item pane, select the **Item Details** icon.
 4. Review the Item Details to identify the location of the SATA ports.
 5. Close the Item Details window after you have found the SATA ports.
2. Install the SATA hard drives.
 1. Switch the computer to the Drive Bays view.
 2. Under Inventory, expand **Storage**.
 3. Drag each hard drive from the Inventory to an open 3.5" drive bay.
3. Attach the SATA cables to the hard drives.
 1. Under Inventory, expand **Cables**.
 2. Select a red SATA cable.
 3. From the Selected Item pane, drag a **SATA** connector to a hard drive.
 4. Under Inventory, select the other red SATA cable.
 5. From the Selected Item pane, drag a **SATA connector** to the second hard drive.
4. Attach the SATA cables to the motherboard.
 1. Switch the computer to the Motherboard view.
 2. Select the **Partial Connections** button, then select a SATA cable.
 3. From the Selected Item pane, drag the unconnected **SATA connector** to a SATA port on the motherboard.
 4. Repeat the previous two steps for the other cable.
5. Connect power to both hard drives.
 1. Switch to the Drive Bays view of the computer.
 2. Above the computer, select **Partial Connections**, then select the **power supply**.
 3. From the Selected Item pane:
 - Drag a **SATA** power connector to one of the hard drives.
 - Drag a different **SATA** power connector to the second hard drive.